The History Department

5-YEAR CURRICULUM OVERVIEW (2026-2027)

Key Stages 3 & 4 (Years 7 – 11)

History Curriculum Map & Enquiry Architecture

YEAR 7

KS3: Water and Sanitation Through Time
Enquiry: Why did it take so long to clean up Britain?
An in-depth study featuring 7 lessons.

Medieval England: 1066–1485
Enquiry: How was power won, maintained, and contested in Medieval England?
An in-depth study featuring 5 lessons.

YEAR 8

Crown, Church, or Parliament (1517–1689)
Enquiry: Who had the right to rule Britain: King, Church, or Parliament?
An in-depth study featuring 5 lessons.

The First British Empire (1600–1783)
Enquiry: How did trade, slavery, and rebellion shape the First British Empire?
An in-depth study featuring 5 lessons.

KS3: The Industrial Revolution (1750–1900)
Enquiry: How did steam, factories, and the fight for democracy transform Britain?
An in-depth study featuring 5 lessons.

KS3: The Second British Empire (1783–1914)
Enquiry: How did trade, conquest, settler colonialism, and anti-colonial resistance shape the Second British Empire?
An in-depth study featuring 5 lessons.

The History of Australia: First Nations, Colonisation & Resistance (1770–1901)
Enquiry: Invasion, Settlement, or Survival? How did British colonisation transform Australia?
An in-depth study featuring 5 lessons.

YEAR 9

KS3: Causes of the Great War
Enquiry: How did decades of imperial rivalry and fear culminate in thirty days of madness?
An in-depth study featuring 6 lessons.

KS3: The Great War (1914–1919)
Enquiry: How did a single spark in Sarajevo ignite a global conflict that transformed the modern world?
An in-depth study featuring 5 lessons.

KS3: The Shoah
Enquiry: How did a modern, civilized nation commit the systematic murder of six million Jewish people?
An in-depth study featuring 7 lessons.

The Cold War & Global Flashpoints (1945–1991)

Enquiry: Why did the ideological clash between Capitalism and Communism bring the world to the brink of nuclear destruction?

An in-depth study featuring 7 lessons.

KS3: Rights, Protest, and Post-War Britain (1900–Present)

Enquiry: How has British identity transformed since 1945?

An in-depth study featuring 6 lessons.

YEAR 10

Paper 2: Conflict in the Middle East, 1945-1995

Enquiry: Why has peace proved so elusive in the Middle East?

Paper 2

Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918-39

Enquiry: From Democracy to Dictatorship: How did Hitler destroy the Weimar Republic?

Paper 3

YEAR 11

Paper 1: Medicine Through Time with the Western Front

Enquiry: How has medicine changed from c1250 to the modern day?

Paper 1

Paper 2: Early Elizabethan England, 1558-88

Enquiry: From religious division to the Armada: How did Elizabeth secure her throne?

Paper 2